



80 per cent of Haskell libraries that use floating point expressions contain instabilities. This plugin fixes them all.
<http://dgit.in/HaskellPlgn>

Getting F(#)unctional

>>F# is the go-to functional programming option available to .NET developers; and is better than C#> by Kshitij Sobti

The # in its name makes F# a functional programming language that is part of the .NET family. Although, it is possibly one of the lesser-used and lesser-known language options available to .NET developers.

What this means is that you can start coding in F# using the free Community edition of the latest Visual Studio, or even using MonoDevelop (which supports Linux and OS X as well). Since it runs on .NET it can run wherever .NET can run.

Just like C++, C#, JavaScript etc. trace their syntax to C and its predecessors, F# can trace its roots in the ML programming language. In fact, you will find that all the code in this article will run in OCaml with minimal modification. OCaml is another language descended from ML, and might be of interest to you if you like F# but don't want to get into .NET.

The F# language is vast, and it's impossible to cover its entire syntax here. So instead we will focus on what makes it different.

Setting up F

Getting a hold of F# is quite easy, as they are clear instructions available on the F# website: <http://fsharp.org/>

On Windows you can install the latest version of Visual Studio Community edition and you will be able to create F# projects. It will automatically install the F# tools.

Another option is to use MonoDevelop, which is available for Linux and OS X as well. Xamarin Studio, a commercial version of

MonoDevelop is also available to OS X and Windows users.

You can get the F# compilers and interpreters for your Linux distro as well if you just want CLI tools.

If you have just the F# compiler installed, simply create a text file ending with '.fsx' in your favourite editor, and type your code in that. This code can then be compiled with the F# compiler located at: `C:\Program Files (x86)\Microsoft SDKs\F#\4.0\Framework\v4.0\fsc.exe`

The interactive interpreter is available on Windows at: `C:\Program Files (x86)\Microsoft SDKs\F#\4.0\Framework\v4.0\fsi.exe`

On Linux and OS X these commands should be available as `fshasrc` and `fsharpi` respectively.

You should also be able to find F# plugins for the free Atom code editor and Sublime Text.

What is a functional Language?

There can be entire books dedicated to elaborating what exactly is a functional language and how F# figures into all of it. Simply put, functions are central to a functional language, such like objects are in an object-oriented language.

Functions are first-class members of a functional language, meaning that they can be passed around to other functions, stored in variables, combined and operated on just like any other value.

Functions can accept other functions as parameters (such func-

*Coding Matters



*Windows 2016 Docker Support

>>The next server edition of Windows will support add support for containers and will work with Docker.

<http://dgit.in/Win16Server>



*Epic Games Frees Art

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<http://dgit.in/FreeInfBlade>



*VP9 Coming to Edge

>>VP9 the open-source and free video format by Google will soon be supported by Microsoft's Edge browser. The only major browser left now is Safari.

<http://dgit.in/VP9Codec>